

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



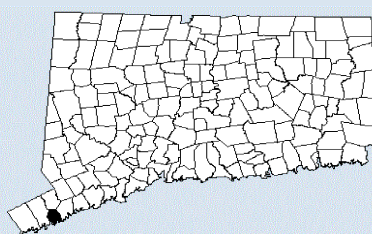
Darien School District

Alan Addley, Superintendent • 203-656-7400 • <http://www.darienps.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	7
Enrollment	4,681
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$24,553
Total Expenditures ¹	\$115,622,368

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	2,403	51.3	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	295	6.3	5.2
Black or African American	35	0.7	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	331	7.1	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	234	5.0	4.7
White	3,781	80.8	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	71	1.5	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	66	1.4	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	966	20.6	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	93	4.1	*	*
Male	116	5.0	*	*
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	22	6.6	8	2.3
White	165	4.5	40	1.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	10	11.8	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	8	8.4	*	*
Students with Disabilities	82	8.6	25	2.3
District	209	4.6	56	1.2
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 50

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Darien School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	348.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	16.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	74.2
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	117.8
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	9.6
School Level	29.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	8.0
Support Staff	4.5
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	23.2
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	37.1
School Nurses	13.1
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	238.8

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	9	1.7	1.4
Black or African American	9	1.7	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	2.2	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.2	0.3
White	505	94.2	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.9	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	34	94.4	28	100.0
White	284	99.0	279	97.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	13	*	8	*
Students with Disabilities	89	94.7	80	93.0
District	350	98.3	334	97.7
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	31	47.7
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	218	79.0
Other Health Impairment	244	79.5
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	122	86.5
District	648	75.6
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Darien School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	71	1.5	2.6
Emotional Disability	37	0.8	1.1
Intellectual Disability	13	0.3	0.6
Learning Disability	277	6.0	6.4
Other Health Impairment	309	6.7	3.5
Other Disabilities	39	0.8	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	163	3.5	2.0
All Disabilities	909	19.8	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	6	0.7	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	29	3.2	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$67,353,157	\$14,303	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$10,557,177	\$2,257	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$5,805,906	\$1,241	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,761,683	\$377	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$7,394,011	\$1,581	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$4,760,898	\$1,018	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$11,074,931	\$2,367	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$4,675,856	\$2,153	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$2,238,751	\$479	\$213
Total	\$115,622,368	\$24,553	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,098,778	20.2	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$4,549,568	12.9	10.2
Other Salaries	\$6,592,290	18.7	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$4,547,813	12.9	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$4,224,924	12.0	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$6,430,822	18.3	22.2
Supplies	\$195,253	0.6	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,483,204	4.2	8.4
Equipment	\$48,673	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$35,171,326	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		30.4	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	94.8
State	3.1
Federal	1.4
Tuition & Other	0.6

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Darien School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	156	90.0	156	92.5	63	87.7
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	169	77.2	168	74.4	70	71.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	125	84.7	125	85.6	41	82.6
White	1,937	81.7	1,934	80.4	824	78.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	57	70.6	57	74.6	17	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,350	82.2	2,346	81.1	992	79.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	35	63.3	35	60.7	18	*
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,372	82.2	2,368	81.2	991	79.4
Students with Disabilities	502	65.9	499	64.0	227	62.2
Students without Disabilities	1,905	86.1	1,904	85.3	782	83.8
High Needs	556	66.8	553	65.7	242	62.3
Non-High Needs	1,851	86.5	1,850	85.4	767	84.2
District	2,407	81.9	2,403	80.9	1,009	78.9

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	88.7	89.3	87.8	87.8	1,373	88.4
Curl Up	92.5	97.9	97.8	90.5	1,367	94.5
Push Up	94.1	93.9	90.6	84.1	1,364	90.7
Mile Run/PACER	95.9	91.8	80.0	66.2	1,361	83.7
All Tests - District	78.8	79.4	67.9	56.9	1,337	70.9
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Darien School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	25	96.0
White	287	98.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	20	90.0
Students with Disabilities	79	93.7
District	343	98.3
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	288	80.4
Male	259	76.2
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	41	64.1
White	454	79.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	11	50.0
Students with Disabilities	75	41.7
District	547	78.4
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2024 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2024 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2024

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	92.3	98.0
Male	87.3	98.2
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	87.5	*
White	91.6	97.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	83.1	95.7
District	89.7	98.1
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Darien School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	81.9	75	50.0	50	100.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	66.8	75	44.5	50	89.1	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	80.9	75	50.0	50	100.0	60.2
	High Needs Students	65.7	75	43.8	50	87.6	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	78.9	75	50.0	50	100.0	61.8
	High Needs Students	62.3	75	41.6	50	83.1	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	73.1%	100%	73.1	100	73.1	58.7%
	High Needs Students	66.4%	100%	66.4	100	66.4	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	74.1%	100%	74.1	100	74.1	61.4%
	High Needs Students	65.0%	100%	65.0	100	65.0	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	82.4%	100%	41.2	50	82.4	58.9%
	Oral	73.4%	100%	36.7	50	73.4	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	4.6%	<=5%	50.0	50	100.0	17.7%
	High Needs Students	8.7%	<=5%	42.6	50	85.2	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	98.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	78.4%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		97.8%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		98.3%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		98.8%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		89.7%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		93.5% 70.9%	75%	47.3	50	94.5	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		62.8%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1276.2	1450	88.0	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	66.8	8.2	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	65.7	9.3	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	62.3	12.7	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	98.8%	0.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.4
	High Needs Students	96.5
Math	All Students	98.2
	High Needs Students	96.0
Science	All Students	98.2
	High Needs Students	93.3

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 68.1

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Darien School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The District Vision of the Graduate in the Darien Public Schools is a guiding document that was developed with input from stakeholders across the community. The six competencies identified within the Vision of the Graduate (VOG): Communication, Creativity, Curiosity, Empathy, Independence, and Integrity represent key attributes valued by the community. The VOG is implemented through the design and instruction of our robust curriculum. The District has established a Curriculum Writing and Revision Cycle and a Curriculum Development Calendar to support the systemic design and implementation of curriculum beginning with the Early Learning Program through Grade 12. The District curriculum is accessible to staff and parents through the Darien Public Schools website.

The District partners with families to ensure high quality programming for students who receive special education services. The District has developed inclusive fine arts programming that offers adaptive music and art instruction. Co-taught classes are available in each of the core disciplines with Math and English labs scheduled to provide additional support. An SRBI process ensures that students receive timely interventions and that parents are included in dialogue about student progress prior to potential referral for special education services. Each school shares information via the website and administration communicates district/school happenings and teaching and learning announcements through weekly communications.

Providing opportunities for parents to share feedback regarding their experience in the school system is reflected in the District's Strategic Plan. Data from a climate survey completed by parents, students, and staff will be used to inform improvement efforts. As the District is engaging in a literacy curriculum review, parents were asked to share feedback and insight about their children's literacy learning experiences. Monthly communications regarding the District's efforts to strengthen teaching and learning in the area of literacy have been shared and will continue in 2024-2025 year as a pilot is initiated to examine potential adjustments to the curriculum including selected resources.

School improvement plans include goals around enhancing teaching and learning, fostering a culture that promotes wellness, diversity, and inclusion and developing a balanced definition of student success through the Vision of the Graduate. School-based teams consistently communicate with parents regarding academic growth, learning goals, attendance and learner engagement. The District has prioritized engaging with families through the design and facilitation of parent workshops on a variety of topics including: the age of entry for Kindergarten given the new legislation, K-3 Literacy, transitions across levels- Early Learning Program to Kindergarten, 5th to 6th, 8th to 9th grade; CT IEP Overview and Continuum of Services, and more. Elementary music shares are opportunities for parents to visit classrooms to watch a lesson, learn about the curriculum, and participate in activities alongside our young musicians. The District is well supported by an engaged parent community and benefits from the efforts of the Council of Darien School Parents, the Wave Booster Club, Darien Advocates for Education of the Gifted and other parent and community based organizations.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The District vision, Preparing all students today to thrive in a changing world tomorrow, provides the focused direction to drive the Strategic Plan which includes clear goals aimed at ensuring academic excellence for all achieved in an environment in which all learners are included and feel a genuine sense of belonging. A review of the District Diversity, Equity and Inclusion report has resulted in the prioritization of considerations and actions that will be implemented through the Strategic Plan.

The Visual and Performing Arts Department facilitates enriching experiences that are supportive of these efforts. The Darien Music for Youth group sponsored a concert featuring the Gertrude Banks Intergenerational Gospel Choir. The choir has grown into an intergenerational ensemble with performers ages 11 through 70, celebrating the American art of Gospel music and providing a place for singers of all levels to perform, learn, and sing together. Elementary choir students participated in the District Wide Choral Festival Concert, United in song, with grades 4-12 DPS Choir students and the WCSU University Choir. Through the curriculum, a variety of resources are used to ensure that our readers have access to texts and enrichment activities with diverse perspectives and themes. Schools have hosted a variety of events including, Celebrations of Diversity: World Diversity Day, and Heritage Night Events. Scholarships for student activities including, are offered for book fairs, field trips, yearbooks, enrichment activities, etc. to ensure access for all students. The District participates in ABC, A Better Chance, a national program that recruits academically promising and motivated students of color from urban areas and places them in high schools that nurture their talent. Students and staff benefit from the Anti-Defamation League's NAMES program, international study abroad and exchange programs.

The District is committed to providing professional learning to support all staff in building an understanding of diverse perspectives and how best to support teaching and learning so that all students are appropriately challenged, achieve to their fullest potential, and so that students are prepared to navigate independently in the ever-changing world.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Darien School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The organizational budget process in the District is designed to ensure that all schools are budgeted for using an equitable formula. The annual budget process appropriates funding in support of each of the District's seven schools in attaining the goals outlined in the District Strategic Plan which center upon enhancing teaching and learning, fostering a culture that promotes wellness, diversity and inclusion, expanding the professional capacity of staff, developing and enhancing systems to promote efficiency, coherence and communication, safety and access to learning, and technology to support teaching and learning.

Budgeting efforts result in rigorous curriculum, high quality instruction, and inclusive experiences for all learners. Darien adheres to guidelines for class size. Professional learning opportunities are targeted and responsive to support individual, department and school needs and continuous improvement. The District also benefits from the generosity of the parent community, community organizations and local businesses. These stakeholders have made impactful contributions to the work of the District.